

Phenom X6 shortage?

AMD is reportedly running short of 6-core silicon – chip shortages spells doom for motherboard makers too!

Sony – autostereoscopic sucks

Sony claims autostereoscopic vision has limitations and they believe the Nintendo 3DS is a weaker device for this feature

Game peripheral test



Razer Destructor

The surface is easier to clean than cloth weaves – a nice plus. Additionally it seems to wear well, although we've hardly used it long enough to comment on longevity. Just make sure it's cleaned well, because any dust causes it to lose grip, and causes erratic mouse movement. Cloth mice have gaps between the weave that fill with dust, there's nothing of the sort here, a wipe with a smooth cloth and you're done. Its well suited to FPS games and RPGs fans alike; the price of Rs. 2,599 is expensive for some, but it's an excellent product. We haven't used this long enough to comment.

Razer Vespula

Razer's Vespula has roughly the same contours as the Destructor, though it is a lot smaller. Build quality seems top notch and the Vespula is a rigid mat. The actual body seems to be made of hard, yet slightly flexible fibre, to which are attached, two mouse surfaces – one on each side. This mousepad is two sided, (as you

may have guessed), and both sides have rubber feet on all four corners to keep it from moving around. This is no cloth surface. Rather the material as described by Razer is an abrasion-resistant hard coat. One of the surfaces on the Vespula is a smooth finish, while the other side has a noticeably more abrasive surface. The smooth surface is called "glide" by Razer, while the other, rougher one is known as "control".

While Razer advertises that these surfaces wear well, and we have no doubt that they do, such surfaces usually wreak havoc on the Teflon feet of the mice. We tried a variety of mice on the Vespula and needless to say it's a pretty decent performer. The surface of the Destructor is actually slap bang in between these two surfaces – it's smoother than the control, but rougher than the glide. The Mamba performs well on the Vespula, a very smooth experience – effortless gliding on the smooth surface. The mouse acceleration is also good, but not erratic. The Destructor might be a little more precise, but there's a hairsbreadth separating the two. Interestingly, the Logitech mice, particularly those with the older, harder Teflon feet make a noticeable sound when moving on both surfaces, whereas the Mamba and Emperor do so silently.



Razer Vespula

The Logitech is also quite accurate on both surfaces, but with the scratching sound. Mouse acceleration is not as good as the Razer mice. The Deathadder feels even rougher than the Logitech G5, since it too, features the same old mouse feet.

Priced at Rs. 1,999, the Vespula is a good buy considering you essentially get two micepads for the price of one. However, both surfaces are quite different, and it's only gamers that would appreciate and utilise the differences fully. Beware though, for the rougher of the two surfaces could well affect longevity of your mice's feet.

Roccat Sense (Glacier Blue)

Roccat's Glacier is a huge mat, measuring 480mm x 280mm. It features a more traditional cloth surface. Roccat claims to use a microcrystalline coating on the surface that increases smoothness by reducing friction between the Teflon feet of the mouse and the surface of the pad. The

rear is rubber that offers superior grip on any surface, meaning your mat will not slide around despite frantic mouse movements.

Initially, the Mamba seemed to track freely on the Sense. After the first minute of use, we found the cloth surface, although smooth to offer marginally more initial resistance, especially when movements are slow and deliberate.

Twitch movements are fast, and response is immediate. In fact, with fast movements slight overtracking happens. We tested this with the Mamba at 2,000 dpi and found the mouse pointer tends to overshoot the target; it's almost like once the initial friction is over, the mouse glides like butter. The Logitech G5 also worked nicely on the Sense – good accuracy, and there's marginally less of a problem with initial resistance. Once you get used to the characteristics of the Sense, there are virtually no problems, however, like all cloth mice, you need to ensure the surface stays clean and doesn't pick up dust. One plus is, the surface seems to be more tightly woven than the surface of the Everglide Titan. It's also a thinner mousepad, this is important, since you wrist is marginally lower, decreasing strain and also affecting human performance favourably.

Priced at Rs. 1,399, the Sense is rather affordable, though anyone but gamers will gawk



Roccat Sense (Glacier Blue)

at this statement. Those wanting unerring accuracy and tracking might prefer the Destructor, since that seems to favour the Razer mice, endowing them with a good mix of speed, accuracy and seamless movement. For many, the slight initial resistance will not be felt, but the discerning few might want to check the Sense out, before buying it. 

Gaming surfaces			
	Roccat Sense	Razer Destructor	Razer Vespula
Price (Rs.)	1,399	2,599	1,999
Plus (+)	huge size, very thin	Accurate, large	Dual sided
Minus (-)	tougher to clean	Expensive	Abrasive to mice feet
Features / Specifications			
Dimensions (mm)	480 x 280	350 x 280	300 x 240
Thickness (mm)	1.35	2.3	4
Surface material	Micro-fibre weave	Fractal (hard fibre)	Hard fibre surface
Bundled packaging	Barrel container	Hard carry case	—
Performance (So 10)			
Tracking	8.5	8.5	8.25
Accuracy	8.5	8.75	8.5
Acceleration	6.75	8	8
Glide	7.25	8.5	8.25